

Sophie Z. Di

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EDUCATION

Cornell University, Duffield College of Engineering, Ithaca, NY **Expected Dec 2028**
Bachelor of Science, Mechanical Engineering, Minors in Computer Science and Artificial Intelligence || **GPA: 4.08 / 4.30**

Relevant Courses: AP Physics C: Mechanics, AP Computer Science A, Linear Algebra, Multivariable Calculus, Differential Equations, Object-Oriented Programming and Data Structures, Physics II - Electromagnetism, Statics and Strength of Solids

EXPERIENCE

Cornell University Physical Intelligence, Ithaca, NY, *Design Lead* **Sep 2025-Present**

- Collaborated with 16 members across mechanical, software, and electrical teams to rapidly prototype and refine components for a symbiotic two-robot system with search-and-rescue capabilities
- Utilized CAD software to construct models for a hexapod robot that met mechanical and spatial constraints
- Overhauled visual design efforts for recruitment and team branding, including logos, posters, and banners

Cornell Maker Club, Ithaca, NY, *Design Officer* **Dec 2025-Present**

- Programmed Arduino and Teensy microcontrollers to integrate electrical components into 3D-printed mechanisms
- Created instructional graphics for workshops to guide new members on personal and collaborative projects
- Won Best Overall out of 30 teams in the 2026 BigRed//Makeathon with a shoulder-mounted posture-correction device that was built from scratch in 24 hours

Podcast AI, Seattle, WA, *Intern* **Jun-Aug 2025**

- Fine-tuned a vision-language model (VLM) and applied prompt engineering techniques to generate long- and short-form video content to boost user engagement on Instagram Reels and YouTube
- Constructed an end-to-end video generation pipeline that produced transcripts, generated voiceovers with the Orpheus TTS model, segmented transcripts into scenes via GPT-5, created images for scenes with the FLUX model, and synthesized clips with the WAN video generation model

Answer AI, Seattle, WA, *Intern* **Jun-Aug 2024**

- Tested early-release features of an AI learning application, systematically documenting user experience issues and providing actionable feedback to guide product improvements
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LEADERSHIP

Liberty High School Marching Band, Seattle, WA, *Personnel Manager* **Aug 2023-Jun 2025**

- Coordinated with seven officers in weekly planning meetings to organize events for a 150-member band

Liberty High School DECA, Seattle, WA, *Chapter Officer* **Oct 2023-Jun 2025**

- Developed free financial literacy classes for 100+ secondary-school students, creating a curriculum from the ground up to promote budgeting, saving, and investing
 - Awarded first place at the Washington DECA State Competition in 2023 and 2024
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SKILLS

Application Software: Excel, PowerPoint, Autodesk Fusion 360, VS Code, Adobe Photoshop, Bambu Studio

Programming Languages: Java, Python, MatLab, HTML

Other: Mandarin (Advanced), Traditional Art, Digital Art, Graphic Design